

My EXACT product research method for Etsy that generated me over \$1,000,000 in sales.

Channel: Takumi Hagino · Published: — · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=13ZzXt4yJ8Y> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Takumi Hagino shares two specific Etsy product research methods — the Bestseller Method and the Review Method — combined with a reverse-image AliExpress sourcing trick, to find proven, profitable dropshipping products.

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🎯 Why Product Research Is the #1 Factor 0:00

- Product research is described as **the single biggest determining factor** of whether an Etsy store succeeds or fails
 - Clean branding, great product photos, and strong SEO are all irrelevant if the product itself is not proven to sell
 - Failing to master product research doesn't just cost money — it wastes months of time and energy
 - The frustration of never hitting a winning product stems directly from skipping proper research
- The methods shared are what Takumi and all of his students actively use

🏆 Method 1: The Bestseller Method 0:47

- **Goal:** Surface the highest-volume selling products in any niche on Etsy right now
- Step-by-step process:
 - Go to etsy.com and type a niche into the search bar (e.g., "women's fashion")
 - Click "Show Filters" (top left) and scroll down to filter by "Star Seller"
 - Star Seller badges are awarded to shops that dispatch on time, have great reviews, and operate professionally — a sign of a reputable, high-volume store
 - In the search URL, locate the word "star" at the end of the filter string and **replace it with "best"**, then press Enter

- This undocumented URL trick surfaces the bestselling products in that niche — all with super high sales volumes in the past 6 months
- Skip the first row of results — those are Etsy ads, not organic bestsellers
- Scroll through the remaining authentic results and identify a product that catches your attention
- Example walkthrough (women's fashion niche):
 - A sweater appeared in results marked as a Bestseller, with 20+ in baskets and 5-star average reviews
 - Identified as a strong candidate to research further
- Finding the supplier using the **Search by Image on AliExpress** Chrome extension:
 - Download the free Chrome extension called "Search by Image on AliExpress"
 - On the Etsy listing, double right-click the product image and select "Search goods on AliExpress by this image"
 - The tool reverse-searches AliExpress to find the same or very similar product
 - The sweater example was found on AliExpress for ~\$7.54 USD (approx. \$28 AUD including shipping of ~\$1 AUD = **~\$30 AUD total COGS**)
 - The same sweater sells on Etsy for **\$70 AUD** — more than a **2x margin**
 - Multiple color variations (white, gray, etc.) were available, adding listing depth
- Key strategic insight:
 - You do NOT need to sell the exact same product as your competitor
 - Find a very similar product that sells well on AliExpress but has NOT yet been heavily listed on Etsy
 - Being first (or early) to that market means less competition and a higher chance of selling

★ **Method 2: The Review Method 3:48**

- **Goal:** Use recent review velocity to confirm a product is actively selling right now
- Step-by-step process:
 - Go to Etsy and search a niche (e.g., "home decor")
 - Click "Show Filters," scroll to Price, and set a **minimum price of \$30 AUD**
 - This eliminates low-ticket products that are hard to scale (require too many customers)
 - Target an **AOV (Average Order Value) of over \$100 AUD** for healthy profit margins
 - Scroll through results and find a product with many reviews and a high star rating
 - Example: a home decor product priced at \$100 AUD, 20+ in baskets, 4.9-star average, with 1,500 total reviews
 - Scroll to the Reviews section of the listing → click "Suggested" → switch to **"Most Recent"**
 - This sorts reviews by newest first, revealing how recently — and how often — people are buying
 - Count the number of reviews left in the past 30 days for that specific product
- **The benchmark rule:**

- If there are **more than 3–5 reviews for that product in the last 30 days**, it is selling very well and is likely a bestseller worth listing
- In the example, there were **6–7 five-star reviews in just the past 2 days** — an extremely strong signal
- Finding the supplier (same reverse-image method as Method 1):
 - The specific home decor product was NOT found on AliExpress — suggesting it may be a handmade or private-label item, not a dropship product
 - In this case, look for a **similar product** on AliExpress that fits the same aesthetic
- Criteria for choosing an AliExpress alternative if an exact match doesn't exist:
 - Looks very similar or matches the same aesthetic as the proven Etsy seller
 - Can be shipped within **7–14 days** (shipping time is critical on Etsy; most AliExpress products fall within this range)
- Core principle: you don't need to clone your competitor exactly — find something that looks alike and sells well

The review velocity trick is the clearest real-time signal of demand: if strangers are leaving reviews day after day, people are actively buying right now.

Closing & Next Steps 6:57

- Takumi encourages viewers to implement both methods in their own Etsy dropshipping businesses
- Call to action: subscribe to the channel for more free value and game
- For 1-on-1 mentorship: DM him on Instagram (@Easy, as mentioned)
- Signed off with a note to make the most of Q4 (the high-sales holiday season)